

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

## CONTENT

• Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



### Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A Tough Upbringing



## Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- Did you have a good childhood?
- What did you use to do when you were young?
- What are some of your best memories?

## Can Do Statements

- I can write about friendships and social activities.
- I can write about habits in the past.
- I can write about actions related to relationships and key life events.

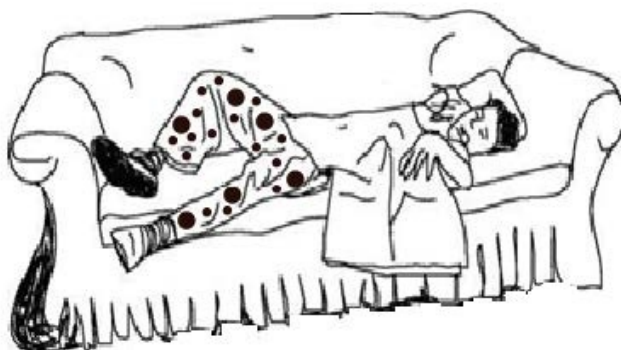




## Let's Explore!

Who is William Scorsesa? How did he become a **couch surfer**\*?

\* A "couch surfer" is a person who does not have a place to live and sleeps on other people's couches.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

**Sally:** Hey buddy, what are you reading?

**Peter:** Oh, there's an online article on William Scorsesa. I'm shocked, to say the least.

**Sally:** Why? I know he's one of your favorite actors.

**Peter:** Well, I assumed that he had a charmed upbringing. It sounds more like a nightmare!

**Sally:** Let me see ... Wow, I didn't realize that he didn't get along with his family.

**Peter:** Neither did I. He went through a horrible breakup with his costar, Mia Farrera!

**Sally:** I guess ... I am reading as fast as I can. It says here that his family used to live close to the poverty line. His father kicked him out at 15 and he would often sleep on people's couches!

**Peter:** He never graduated from high school. He used to take weekly night classes and received his diploma in his twenties.

**Sally:** I heard that he was spotted by a modeling agency in his late teens. His acting career followed. He would go to every casting call he could until someone noticed him.

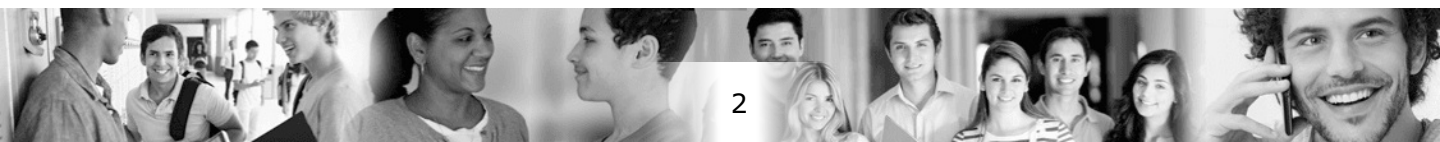
**Peter:** I read that somewhere too.

**Sally:** He has since settled down, got married and now lives on the north side.

**Peter:** Yeah, I often see him on my online feed, spending time with friends, eating out and the occasional selfie at the gym. You really never know about the lives of others.

**Sally:** It really does make me appreciate my life and think about all the things I take for granted.

**Peter:** Absolutely! He has been through so much!





## Let's Practice!

Can you identify the phrasal verbs in these sentences?

*Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

1. settled / north / since / on / has / the / He / side / now / and / down / lives / .

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2. family / didn't / get / along / with / that / realize / didn't / I / his / . / he

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3. William / out / with / likes / friends / eating / .

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4. He / breakup / with / Farrera / Mia / horrible / went / costar, / ! / his / a / through

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## Let's Practice!

What was William's upbringing like? What happened?

*Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Cross out the incorrect words. Write the sentences correctly.*

1. It says here that his family uses to lived close to the poverty line.

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2. His father kick him out at 15 and he would often slept on people's couches!

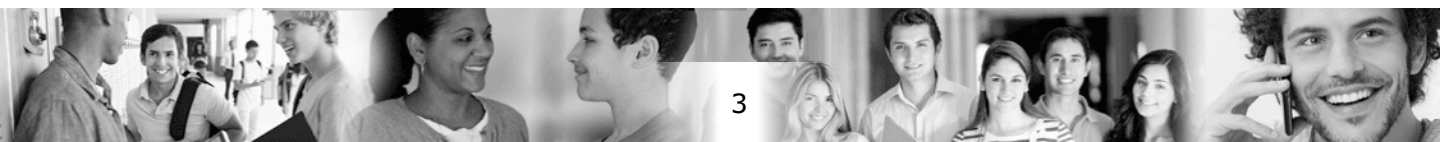
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3. He used to took weekly night classes and receives his diploma in his twenties.

---

4. He would went to every casting call he could until someone notices him.

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## Extension Activity

How much do you know about the people around you?

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Interview a partner or family member about their friends' lifestyles.
- Find out the names of their closest friends and the social activities they enjoy.
- Ask about past habits. What did they use to do that they do not do anymore?
- Write down any phrasal verbs they use in the conversation.
- Write a short paragraph about the person based on the interview.
- Then, read the paragraph aloud to the person.
- What is their response?

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I interview a person about their friends and lifestyle.

☐ ☐

I ask about past habits.

☐ ☐

I write a short paragraph based on notes from an interview.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **to say the least** (expression): to suggest there is a lot more to a subject  
e.g. I'm shocked, to say the least.
- **charmed** (adjective): very lucky  
e.g. I assumed that he had a charmed life.
- **upbringing** (noun): how a person is raised  
e.g. He had a hard upbringing.
- **poverty line** (noun): the level of income that makes it possible for a person to pay for basic food, clothing, and shelter  
e.g. It says here that his family used to live close to the poverty line.
- **modeling agency** (noun): a business that employs people to wear clothing and accessories  
e.g. I heard that he was spotted by a modeling agency in his late teens.
- **casting call** (noun): an acting audition  
e.g. He would go to every casting call he could until someone noticed him.
- **online feed** (noun): regular online updates about people and events  
e.g. I often see him on my online feed.
- **selfie** (noun): a picture that someone takes of themselves  
e.g. I take the occasional selfie at the gym.





## Learning Points

### Used to and Would

**Would** and **used to** have similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer.

However, there is an important difference between **used to** and **would**.

**Would** is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while **used to** does not require this. Read the following examples:

*We would play baseball every afternoon when we were children.*

*We used to play baseball every afternoon.*

When you use the question form of used to, be careful to drop the 'd'. For example:

*Did you **use to** play baseball every afternoon?*

#### Examples:

- *He used to take weekly night classes and received his diploma in his twenties.*
- *He would go to every casting call he could until someone noticed him.*
- *His father kicked him out at 15 and he would often sleep on people's couches!*
- *It says here that his family used to live close to the poverty line.*





## Learning Points

### Phrasal verbs

Phrasal verbs consist of a verb and one or more prepositions. They are often used, especially in informal spoken English. The meaning of phrasal verbs is often completely different from the meaning of the verb alone.

Phrasal verbs can either be separable or inseparable.

Separable phrasal verbs consist of two parts. They always require an object.

The object of a phrasal verb can go either between the verb and the preposition or after the preposition.

#### Examples:

*I handed in my homework.*

*I handed my homework in.*

If the object of the sentence is a pronoun, it must go between the two parts of the phrasal verb.

*I handed it in.*

Some phrasal verbs are inseparable, so the verb must be directly followed by its preposition or adverb. Otherwise, the meaning of the phrasal verb will be incorrect.

Some inseparable phrasal verbs never use an object.

#### Examples:

- get up = get out of bed

*I get up at seven o'clock every morning.*

- take off = leave the ground

*The plane took off on time.*

- look out = beware! be careful!

*Look out! That car is going to hit you!*

#### **Examples:**

- *Yeah, I often see him on my online feed, spending time with friends, eating out and the occasional selfie at the gym.*

